

March 6, 2025

Dear Dr. Metters,

I am pleased to submit my annual review detailing my contributions to the Department of Information and Operations Management at Mays Business School. This past year has been extraordinarily productive, marked by significant achievements in course development and service to the university while continuing in my research program of teaching and learning.

In the past year, I have undertaken extensive course development activities, creating and teaching six distinct courses that significantly expand our department's offerings in cloud computing and data management. These developments include a new in-person Cloud special topics course (what became ISTM 665), two online Cloud special topics courses for the Online MS in MIS program, ISTM 615 for both the FlexOnline MS in MIS and MBA programs (with distinct versions for each), ISTM 610 covering networking and cloud infrastructure, and ISTM 622 focusing on advanced data management. Each of these courses represents a substantial investment in curriculum development, requiring the creation of original content, assignments, rubrics, and video lectures. Let me describe each course briefly.

The in-person Cloud special topics course, which will become ISTM 665, represented a significant new preparation. I developed this course utilizing Amazon Web Services (AWS) educational content and designed several custom projects where students worked in groups to develop serverless architecture applications addressing real-world business problems. As a new course offering, I created all teaching materials, assignments, and grading rubrics without the benefit of grading support (since no students had ever taken the course) or existing course materials to build upon.

For the Online MS in MIS program, I developed and taught two Cloud special topics courses in late Spring and early Summer 2024. These courses, which built on the face-to-face special topics class, required substantial adaptation to suit the online asynchronous learning environment. Students engaged in building applications in the Cloud using serverless architecture, with all new materials and assignments specifically designed for the unique challenges and opportunities of online learning.

ISTM 615 for the FlexOnline MS in MIS program was developed under a compressed timeline due to staffing changes and launched in Fall 2024. This comprehensive development effort included determining and arranging topics, creating assignments and rubrics, scripting and recording videos, and working closely with the editing team to ensure all content met our high standards. After the editing team completed their initial cuts, I reviewed and corrected any issues until all videos were approved for release.

The MBA version of ISTM 615 for the FlexOnline program required a significant reimagining of the course content to meet the distinct needs of MBA students. While the MS version focuses on the technical aspects of structuring data for efficient storage and retrieval, the MBA version emphasizes identifying existing data sources and generating strategic insights to drive business decisions. Although some video content from the FlexOnline MS in MIS program could be repurposed, I created new module openers, closers, introductions, and content specific to the MBA audience. Additionally, I developed unique assignments, rubrics, and support materials that aligned with the MBA program's focus on strategic decision-making rather than technical implementation.

The development of ISTM 610 for the FlexOnline MS in MIS program spanned Summer and Fall 2024, focusing on networking and cloud infrastructure topics. While I could draw from my experience teaching ISTM 310 to undergraduates, this graduate-level course required substantial new development and elevation of content. I determined and sequenced topics, created custom learning materials since no textbook that covers the right blend of business and technology exists, created new hands-on labs, developed assignments and quizzes, and created comprehensive grading rubrics. The course development process included writing video scripts, recording content, and working through multiple rounds of corrections and approvals. Despite the additional challenge of working with three different instructional designers due to staffing changes - which required significant time investment to bring each new ID up to speed - we successfully created a robust and comprehensive course package.

ISTM 622 for the FlexOnline MS in MIS program involved adapting our existing in-person course to work within the FlexOnline structure. This advanced data management course covers critical topics such as clustering relational databases and transitioning data into NoSQL for improved performance at current data scales. The development process included scripting, recording, and approving videos, as well as adapting assignments and creating rubrics. Despite the same challenges of working with three different Instructional Designers due to staffing changes, we are successfully launching the course in Spring 2025.

My role as Co-director of the Council for the Management of Information Systems (CMIS) has been both challenging and rewarding as I finished out my first academic year and began my second year in 2024. This position requires extensive planning and execution of numerous events that connect our students with industry partners and enhance their professional development opportunities. I am fortunate to work with excellent department staff like Veronica, Jana, and Sarah, as well as my co-director Dwayne in planning and executing these events. We have been trained a student worker to assist us in maintaining excellence. Together, we have seen a net revenue increase of \$24,000 by signing four new companies: Palo Alto, Umbrage, Phillips66, and Booz Allen. We have also been able to reign in expenses by carefully planning and executing events.

Throughout the year, I helped orchestrate several signature events that are crucial to our students' success. The case competitions in Spring and Fall provided students with opportunities to tackle real-world business challenges, developing their analytical and presentation skills while networking with industry professionals. My role included creating the custom case, assigning student groups to presentation times, coordinating the presentations, recruiting judges, distributing feedback, arranging the final round on Friday, making sure everyone was where they needed to be, and holding an awards banquet to celebrate student achievement. This is our signature 2-day event that every undergraduate student completes twice during their time in our major and is held twice a year. We include CMIS board members, former students, and friends of the department as judges. This helps with not only providing external feedback to students, but also keeps our former students and friends connected. This event has helped us recruit new companies to the CMIS board.

The MIS Career Nights, held in both Fall and Spring semesters, serves as vital outreach events where industry speakers shared their passion for MIS with students who are either new to the major or considering it as their field of study. These events have proven instrumental in helping students understand the diverse career opportunities available in the MIS field.

The Fall semester was particularly active with the execution of our career fair preparation workshop, the career fair itself, and the speed networking honors event. These activities provide structured

opportunities for our students to connect with potential employers and industry professionals. This year, we innovated by making our career fair an all-day event where students were able to get resume feedback and participate in mock interviews in the morning and early afternoon before the full career fair in the evening.

A significant achievement this year was the planning and execution of our first Leadership in Technology AI conference, which notably achieved profitability in its inaugural year. With the Foundation's help, we identified a sponsor to underwrite most of the costs of the conference and raised over \$10,000 in registrations for the conference. For a new conference, we consider this a success but built on this success as we planned the second conference, which was executed in 2025 and will thus be explained in more detail next year. This conference brings together industry leaders, academics, and students to explore cutting-edge developments in AI technology.

We also introduced new networking opportunities, such as the Baseball social in Spring, which created a more relaxed environment for board members and students to interact and build relationships and continued old ones like the football tailgate. These events complement our traditional networking activities and provide a different context for meaningful connections to develop.

Throughout the year, I participated in annual former student and friends of the department visits in Austin, San Antonio, and Houston, helping to maintain and strengthen our alumni network. While I was unable to attend the Dallas event due to a schedule conflict, I assisted in its planning. These regional events are crucial for maintaining strong connections with our alumni base and industry partners.

A key aspect of my role involves ongoing communication with current and prospective board members to reinforce relationships and ensure continued engagement with our program. This regular interaction helps maintain the vitality of our industry partnerships and creates opportunities for our students. Despite the challenges of coordinating multiple events and managing various stakeholders, we have maintained strong relationships and continued to expand our network of industry partners.

As Director of Artificial Intelligence for Teaching Innovation, I am advancing the adoption and effective use of AI technologies across Mays Business School. A significant portion of this responsibility involves managing our relationship with BoodleBox, where I serve as the primary liaison between faculty and the platform's leadership team. This has included providing comprehensive login support for faculty members, troubleshooting various technical issues as they arise, and working directly with France (co-founder, co-CEO, and chairman) and Meredith (head of marketing) to advocate for and secure new features needed by our faculty and remain compliant with state laws.

To facilitate broader AI adoption and understanding, I designed and implemented a series of monthly workshops for faculty focusing on various AI tools and their applications in academic settings. These workshops have served as a forum for faculty to learn about new technologies, share experiences, and develop best practices for AI integration in their teaching. Additionally, I created documentation to help faculty members quickly come up to speed with the available tools, ensuring they could effectively implement these technologies in their courses.

License management has been another crucial aspect of my role. As faculty and staff members departed Mays, I carefully managed the reallocation of licenses to ensure maximum utility and accessibility for

remaining and new faculty members. This required maintaining detailed records and coordinating with various departments to ensure seamless transitions.

A particularly exciting initiative has been the design and launch of an AI learning community, which began in Spring 2025. This involved carefully selecting and recruiting faculty members who showed interest in advancing their AI knowledge and implementation skills. The learning community serves as a collaborative space where faculty can explore AI applications in teaching, share insights, and develop innovative approaches to incorporating AI into their pedagogical practices. This initiative represents a significant step forward in our school's commitment to embracing and effectively utilizing AI technologies in higher education.

My service contributions at both the college and university levels have expanded significantly through participation in three important committees. As a member of the APT Faculty Council at Mays Business School, I helped establish the foundation of this new organization by contributing to the writing of its bylaws prior to its formal formation. My colleagues in the department demonstrated their trust by electing me to serve as their representative on this council. In this role, I work to bridge communication between APT faculty and the Dean's office, bringing forward concerns and collaborating on solutions that enhance the working environment for all APT faculty members.

At the university level, my service on the APTF Committee has provided an opportunity to participate in shared governance at Texas A&M. This role involves serving as a crucial link between the college-level concerns and the Faculty Senate. I actively bring forward issues identified at the college level for consideration by the Faculty Senate while ensuring that important information and decisions from the Senate are effectively communicated back to the college level. This bi-directional communication flow helps ensure that APT faculty voices are heard and considered in university-wide decision-making processes, and has been a great link to my service on the College-level APT Council.

The Academic Freedom Council represents another significant service commitment at the university level. This important role involves providing guidance to the Provost on both external and internal matters pertaining to academic freedom. I received specialized training to evaluate and report on academic freedom concerns that are referred to us through the grievance process. Working through Faculty Affairs, this council plays a vital role in protecting and promoting academic freedom within our institution. This responsibility requires careful consideration of complex issues and the ability to provide well-reasoned guidance that upholds our university's commitment to academic freedom, academic responsibility, and other institutional considerations.

In addition to my university service, I have continued my role as a board member of ISCAP (Information Systems and Computing Academic Professionals), contributing to initiatives that advance information systems education across institutions. A particularly exciting project has been my involvement in developing a cross-university syllabus sharing system which we hope to launch in 2025. This innovative platform leverages generative AI technology to analyze and suggest improvements to course syllabi, helping faculty members enhance their course design and delivery. This collaborative effort aims to streamline the sharing of best practices in information systems education while utilizing cutting-edge AI technology to provide actionable insights for course improvement. This project exemplifies the intersection of traditional academic collaboration with emerging technologies, potentially transforming how educators develop and refine their course materials.

My research contributions this year included a presentation published in the proceedings at the Information Systems and Computing Academic Professionals (ISCAP) conference in October and which is under second-round review for ISEDJ. The paper, which focuses on implementing Amazon Web Services (AWS) in the classroom, was recognized as a meritorious paper, placing it in the top 15% of conference submissions. This research documented effective methodologies for incorporating cloud computing technologies into information systems education, sharing best practices and lessons learned from our course implementations at Texas A&M. The recognition of this work as meritorious validates our approach to integrating cutting-edge technology into our curriculum and contributes to the broader academic discussion on teaching cloud computing concepts in higher education.

To continue to enhance my research skills and broaden my network, I joined the Scholarship of Teaching Yields Learning Excellence (STYLE) development community. Together, we learn theories and methodologies for conducting Scholarship of Teaching and Learning (SoTL) projects that are more likely to be published in top journals. From successful completion of this process, I earned an invitation to join the Innovation and Design For Exploration and Analysis in Teaching Excellence (IDEATE) community in 2025 and look forward to collaborating with peers from across campus on SoTL research.

To also enhance my awareness of on-campus tools and opportunities, I attended the annual Transformational Teaching and Learning Conference here at Texas A&M University. I had the opportunity to share what I know and learn about exciting developments in technology and tools available through Canvas.

I am pleased to report that my teaching once again won me the student-voted Best Professor award at the graduate level in 2024. This is an award that I prize because it shows that what I am doing in the classroom is appreciated by my students. While I enjoy the success, I continue to rebuild my courses to improve every semester.

Looking ahead, I am excited to build upon this year's accomplishments with several key initiatives. One significant goal is the expansion of our Leadership in Technology AI conference in 2026 to include an Academic track for research presentations. This addition will create a unique forum where practitioners and academics can collaborate on solving tomorrow's challenges, bridging the gap between theoretical research and practical application. By bringing together these two communities, we aim to foster innovative solutions to emerging technological challenges while expanding the reach and impact of our conference.

I am also pursuing several scholarly publications. The custom cases I developed for our case competition will be prepared for submission through ISCAP, making these valuable teaching tools available to other institutions and contributing to the broader information systems education community. Additionally, I am collaborating with departmental colleagues on revising a manuscript focused on Faculty Learning Communities, examining their effectiveness in promoting faculty development and innovation in teaching methodologies. We are preparing this manuscript for journal submission, incorporating insights from our experiences implementing these communities at Mays Business School.

Furthermore, I am embarking on original basic research investigating how the form of information provided by AI systems influences human trust in that information. This new research direction explores a critical aspect of human-AI interaction, with important implications for both education and business applications. Alongside these research goals, I remain committed to teaching excellence and continuing

my service to the department, college, and university. The combination of these research initiatives, the expansion of our conference, and my ongoing teaching and service commitments reflects my dedication to advancing both scholarship and practice in our field while contributing to our institutional mission.

Sincerely,

David Gomillion